ITEC 2026 · AGENTIC AI FOR SCHOOL LEADERS

Replace, Modify, Keep

Auditing your EdTech stack with Agentic AI

Cory Houghton · Technology Director, Earlham CSD · choughton@ecsdcards.com

TRY IT DURING THE SESSION

Email me right now

choughton@ecsdcards.com

Subject line: ITEC

Ask a question, describe a problem at your school, or just say hi. Later in this session, an AI agent will read and summarize your emails and draft replies, live on screen.

Please keep it professional, and don't send anything private. It will be on the screen.

Cory Houghton · Technology Director, Earlham CSD

SESSION GOAL

See what Agentic AI can take off your software bill, and what it can't

Replace

Tools that only report on data you already own

Modify

Keep a smaller tier, or only the part we can't build

Keep

Systems that hold the data or carry legal weight

EARLHAM'S SOFTWARE BILL

Here's what we're going to try not to pay

Tool	Annual cost	Decision
PowerSchool (SIS)	$12,000	Keep
Schoology (LMS)	$5,000	Keep
Special Programs (504/IEP)	$5,000	Keep
Enrollment	$3,000	Keep for now
Document/License Management	$5,000	Keep
Data Analytics	$5,000	Replace
Attendance Module	$5,000	Replace
School Messenger	$5,000	Modify → Replace later
District website	$10,000	Replace
Total (without website)	$55,000	

Keep the systems that hold the data. Replace the tools that just report or take actions on the data.

THE MENTAL MODEL

What is Agentic AI?

Regular LLM

Like asking a knowledgeable colleague a question. You get an answer, then it's back to you.

Agentic AI

Like handing that colleague a project. They figure out the steps, use the tools available, and make the product.

BEFORE YOU START

What you need, and what's nice to have

NEED

Paid AI account

Claude or ChatGPT, paid. Agent features like Cowork and connectors need it.

NEED

Your data

Your kids' numbers, and one ID that ties them together across systems.

NICE TO HAVE

SIS admin access

Pull straight from your SIS instead of exporting by hand.

NICE TO HAVE

API access

Lets scripts grab data on a schedule. Exports work fine to start.

NICE TO HAVE

Some code experience

Not required. Claude writes the code, but reading it helps.

NICE TO HAVE

Compute

A fast computer or server space for nightly runs and big pulls.

THE SORT

Replace, Modify, Keep

Replace

- Data Analytics
- Attendance Module
- District website
- Mail merges, walkthrough spreadsheets

Modify

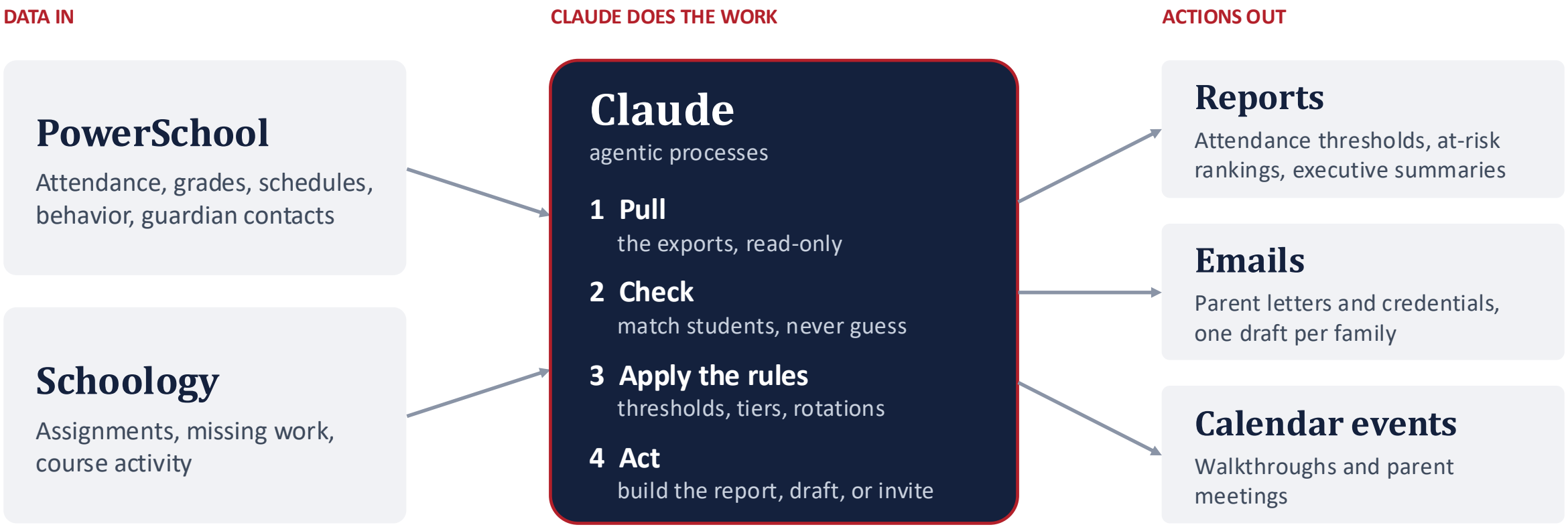
- School Messenger (targeted email now, emergency later)
- Survey add-ons
- Grant-search subscriptions

Keep

- PowerSchool
- Schoology
- Special Programs
- Enrollment (for now)
- Document/License Mgmt
- Staff absence / subs

THE DATA WORKFLOW

Systems of record in, actions out



Read-only in · Drafts, not sends · A human checks before anything goes out

RECORDED WALKTHROUGH

Observation scheduler

Replaces: walkthrough spreadsheets and principal/secretary hours

- Reads the PowerSchool course schedule
- Compares it with the principal's calendar
- Builds 20-minute walkthroughs, rotating teachers and subjects

LIVE DEMO · EASY WIN #1

Email summarizer

Replaces: nothing paid. This is the on-ramp

- Reads the latest inbox messages
- Summarizes each one
- Drafts replies. Nothing sends on its own

PARENT CREDENTIALS, AUG 2026

From a risky mail merge to one checked draft per family

Before

- Mail merge of PowerSchool + Schoology codes
- Easy to send a code to the wrong parent
- ~3 hours of setup

After

- Codes matched to guardian emails
- One Gmail draft per family; a human sends
- 358 family emails (646 students)
- Under 20 minutes

PARENT CREDENTIALS · WHERE THE DATA CAME FROM

Two systems, one safe match, one draft per family

Built by: Claude wrote the code. I set the rules: read-only, never guess, drafts only

- **PowerSchool:** codes and guardian email from the same student record
- **One read-only query** added to our plugin. The codes aren’t in the API by default
- **Schoology:** API export of 1,071 parent access codes
- **The match:** attach a code only if exactly one student has that name. Never guess
- **Result:** 645 matched automatically, 1 by hand, 0 missing guardian emails
- **Families, not students:** 646 students → 358 emails. Reviewed, then a person sent them

BACKUP IF THE DEMO FAILS

One family's draft

[Screenshot: sa

Cory Houghton <choughton@ecsdcards.com>

Your 2026–27 parent access — PowerSchool, Schoology, Securly & JAMF
1 message

Cory Houghton <choughton@ecsdcards.com> Sun, Aug 16, 2026 at 4:22 PM
To: [redacted]

Dear Parent/Guardian of [redacted]

Welcome to the 2026–27 school year! To help you stay connected with your students — and manage the device they use at school — here is the access information for the tools we use:

- **PowerSchool Parent Portal** — grades, attendance, and report cards
- **Schoology** — the online classroom where teachers post assignments and materials
- **Securly** — the web filter that monitors student web activity
- **JAMF Parent** — tools to manage your student's school iPad at home

Please keep the codes below private — they are unique to your family.

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1. PowerSchool Parent Portal (grades & attendance)

If you haven't set up your PowerSchool Parent Account yet, you'll want to, for access to your students' information. Go to https://earlham.powerschool.com/public/home.html, click the **Create Account** tab, and enter the Access ID and Access Password below for your student. You can enter multiple students at one time. If you already have an account for an older student, just log in for that student and add your new ones once you are logged in.

[redacted]
Access ID: [redacted]
Access Password: [redacted]

[redacted]
Access ID: [redacted]
Access Password [redacted]

[redacted]
Access ID [redacted]
Access Password: [redacted]

Please set up your account on the web before using the mobile app. The district code for the mobile app is **RPST**.
Video guides: logging in on the web · setting up the mobile app

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PRINCIPAL DASHBOARD

Where the license money is

Replaces

Data Analytics ($5,000)
Attendance Module ($5,000)

Reads from

PowerSchool · Schoology · ISASP · behavior logs · Gmail · Calendar

Runs on

An existing district server.
One nightly snapshot

LIVE DEMO · 1 OF 4

Problematic attendance

Replaces: the Attendance Module

- All three buildings, counted the way the state defines chronic absence
- Students tiered in week 1, not at the first grading period
- New: tiered parent letters, drafts only, with a sent log

ATTENDANCE · WHAT THE PRINCIPAL GETS

Students at 10%, 15% and 20%, with every date

Earlham Elementary School

Students at Attendance Thresholds

August 24 – October 11, 2026 | 32 school days | Grades K–5

Absence rate	Students
20% or more	0
15% to 19.9%	8
10% to 14.9%	4

10% of the school days so far is 3.2 days. Chronic absence (federal and Iowa) = missing 10% or more of school days. Exempt absences (codes ending in X, such as MEDX, RELX, IEPX, 504X) and H-MEDX half days (doctor note) are NOT counted in this report.

20% or more absent (0 students)

None.

15% to 19.9% absent (8 students)

Student	Gr	Absent	Dates and codes
S-6ABKCD	1	6 of 32 (18.8%)	9/11 FAM, 9/14 FAM, 9/15 FAM, 9/16 FAM, 9/17 FAM, 9/18 FAM
S-8ZWQP4	4	5.5 of 32 (17.2%)	8/27 H-MedP (½), 8/31 H-MedP (½), 9/2 H-MedP (½), 9/10 H-MedP (½), 9/17 MEDP, 9/23 H-MedP (½), 9/28 H-MedP (½), 10/6 H-MedP (½), 10/7 OSS
S-GABW7U	3	5 of 32 (15.6%)	9/14 FAM, 9/15 FAM, 9/16 FAM, 9/17 FAM, 9/18 FAM
S-RCAN2Q	3	5 of 32 (15.6%)	9/16 FAM, 9/17 FAM, 9/18 FAM, 9/22 FAM, 9/23 FAM
S-VHEE7E	1	5 of 32 (15.6%)	8/31 MEDP, 9/23 MEDP, 9/24 MEDP, 10/6 MEDP, 10/7 MEDP
S-JWGQM9	5	5 of 32 (15.6%)	9/14 FAM, 9/15 FAM, 9/16 FAM, 9/17 FAM, 9/18 FAM
S-Z8SU5N	K	5 of 32 (15.6%)	9/14 FAM, 9/15 FAM, 9/16 FAM, 9/17 FAM, 9/18 FAM
S-NXXUFV	K	5 of 32 (15.6%)	9/16 FAM, 9/17 FAM, 9/18 FAM, 9/22 FAM, 9/23 FAM

10% to 14.9% absent (4 students)

Student	Gr	Absent	Dates and codes
S-XGTUGQ	K	4.5 of 32 (14.1%)	9/28 H-FAM (½), 9/29 FAM, 9/30 FAM, 10/1 FAM, 10/2 FAM
S-Z2SN6N	3	4 of 32 (12.5%)	9/4 MEDP, 9/25 FAM, 10/8 MEDP, 10/9 MEDP
S-KC577E	1	4 of 32 (12.5%)	8/31 MEDP, 9/23 MEDP, 9/24 MEDP, 9/25 MEDP
S-3EJA9U	1	3.5 of 32 (10.9%)	8/27 MEDP, 9/1 MEDP, 9/2 MEDP, 9/29 H-MedP (½)

Elementary, 28 days in

- 15 students at 10%+ (1 · 7 · 7)
- Every absence date and code, so the office can check it
- Exempt "X" codes left out
- Matched PowerSchool's ADA/ADM report

ATTENDANCE · PARENT LETTERS

One letter per tier, one draft per family

10%: Notice

"We noticed, and we want to help"
Dates listed so parents can catch errors

15%: Meeting

"Let's make a plan together"
Asks for times to meet

20%: Required

Required meeting
The district's next steps start here

Dry run → review sheet → Gmail drafts → a person sends → sent log

Elementary this week: 15 students, 13 emails (siblings share one). No family gets the same letter twice.

Attendance letters, through 2026-10-04

DEMO DATA: made-up families. Drafts only; nothing has been sent.

20% required meeting

To: parent.sample@example.com
Subject: Important: attendance for Ava

Dear parent or guardian of Ava,

We need to talk with you about attendance. So far this year (out of 28 school days):

Ava Sample (grade 2): missed 6 of 28 days (21.4%)
Dates: 9/11, 9/14, 9/15, 9/16, 9/17, 9/18

Missing 20% of school days is serious, and the district has required steps it must follow at this level. We want to work through this with you first. Please contact us within the next few days so we can set up a meeting and an attendance plan.

If you think a date above is wrong, let the office know and we'll check it.

Thank you,
[Principal Name]
Principal, Earlham Elementary School
[phone]

LIVE DEMO · 2 OF 4

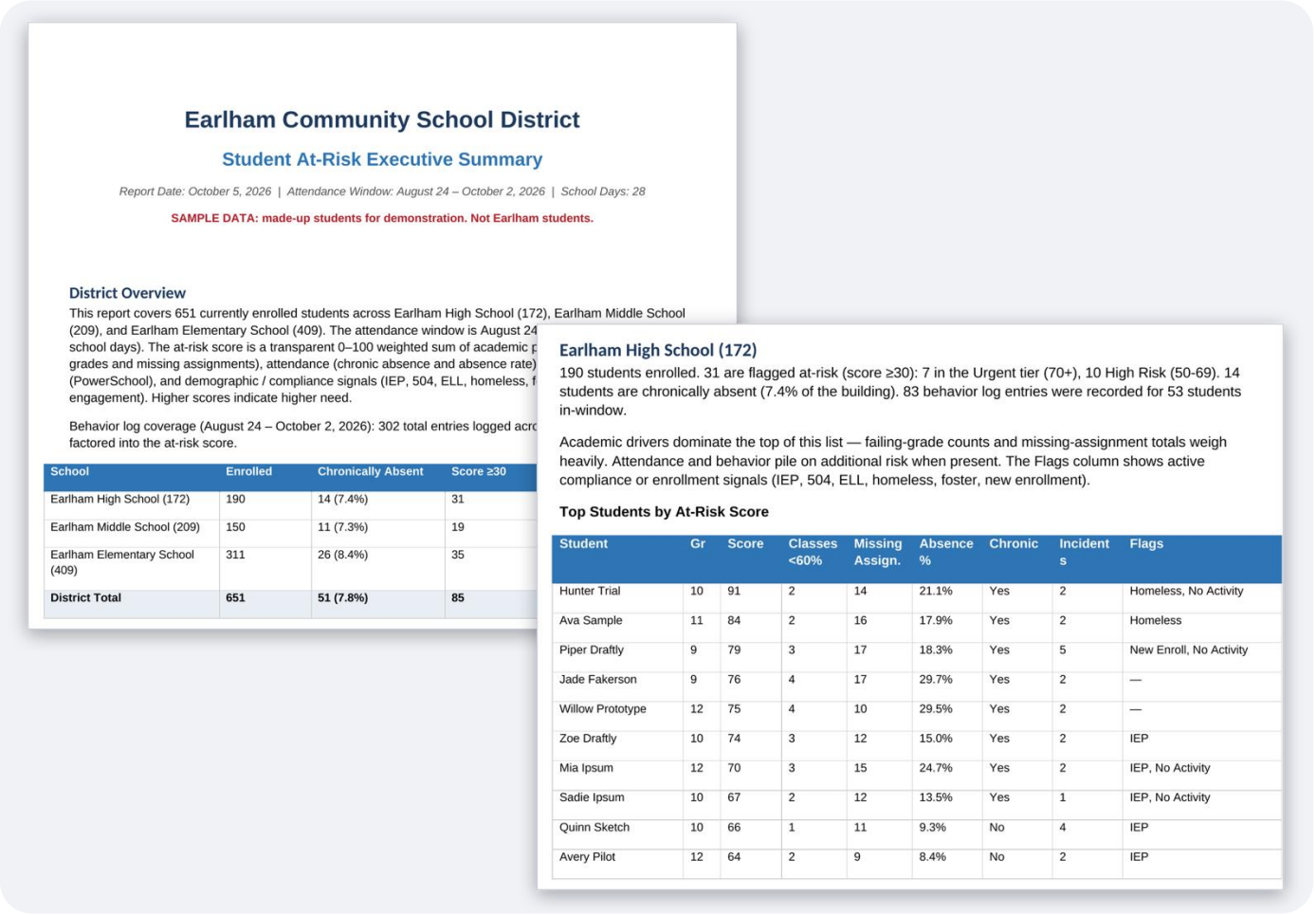
At-risk students

Replaces: Data Analytics dashboards

- One composite score: attendance, missing work, grades, ISASP, behavior
- Sorted so the kids who need an adult first are at the top
- Click into one student's detail

AT-RISK · WHAT THE PRINCIPAL GETS

Every building, ranked by who needs an adult first



Earlham Community School District

Student At-Risk Executive Summary

Report Date: October 5, 2026 | Attendance Window: August 24 – October 2, 2026 | School Days: 28

SAMPLE DATA: made-up students for demonstration. Not Earlham students.

District Overview

This report covers 651 currently enrolled students across Earlham High School (172), Earlham Middle School (209), and Earlham Elementary School (409). The attendance window is August 24 school days). The at-risk score is a transparent 0–100 weighted sum of academic p grades and missing assignments), attendance (chronic absence and absence rate) (PowerSchool), and demographic / compliance signals (IEP, 504, ELL, homeless, f engagement). Higher scores indicate higher need.

Behavior log coverage (August 24 – October 2, 2026): 302 total entries logged acr factored into the at-risk score.

School	Enrolled	Chronically Absent	Score ≥30
Earlham High School (172)	190	14 (7.4%)	31
Earlham Middle School (209)	150	11 (7.3%)	19
Earlham Elementary School (409)	311	26 (8.4%)	35
District Total	**651**	**51 (7.8%)**	**85**

Earlham High School (172)

190 students enrolled. 31 are flagged at-risk (score ≥30): 7 in the Urgent tier (70+), 10 High Risk (50-69). 14 students are chronically absent (7.4% of the building). 83 behavior log entries were recorded for 53 students in-window.

Academic drivers dominate the top of this list — failing-grade counts and missing-assignment totals weigh heavily. Attendance and behavior pile on additional risk when present. The Flags column shows active compliance or enrollment signals (IEP, 504, ELL, homeless, foster, new enrollment).

Top Students by At-Risk Score

Student	Gr	Score	Classes <60%	Missing Assign.	Absence %	Chronic	Incidents	Flags
Hunter Trial	10	91	2	14	21.1%	Yes	2	Homeless, No Activity
Ava Sample	11	84	2	16	17.9%	Yes	2	Homeless
Piper Draftly	9	79	3	17	18.3%	Yes	5	New Enroll, No Activity
Jade Fakerson	9	76	4	17	29.7%	Yes	2	—
Willow Prototype	12	75	4	10	29.5%	Yes	2	—
Zoe Draftly	10	74	3	12	15.0%	Yes	2	IEP
Mia Ipsum	12	70	3	15	24.7%	Yes	2	IEP, No Activity
Sadie Ipsum	10	67	2	12	13.5%	Yes	1	IEP, No Activity
Quinn Sketch	10	66	1	11	9.3%	No	4	IEP
Avery Pilot	12	64	2	9	8.4%	No	2	IEP

Sample district, 28 days in

- 651 students, one 0–100 score each
- 85 at-risk, 11 of them urgent
- Top 10 per building, with the reasons beside each score
- One command rebuilds it. Nobody exports or formats it

LIVE DEMO · 3 OF 4

Ask in plain English

Replaces: report builders and export-and-filter work

1 "Chronically absent 9th graders with 2+ missing assignments"

Ask · student snapshot — 4 of 651 students

Student	Absent	Missing	Below 60%
Jade Fakerson	29.7%	17	4
Piper Draftly	18.3%	17	3
Rowan Example	12.4%	6	1
Colt Mockler	10.9%	3	0

Filter it wrote: grade = 9 · absence ≥ 10% · missing ≥ 2
Sorted by at-risk score · Export to CSV

Read-only. It queries the snapshot and never writes to PowerSchool.

2 "Draft emails to their parents"

Gmail · Drafts — DRAFT · NOT SENT

To: parent.sample@example.com

Check-in regarding Jade Fakerson

Dear parent or guardian of Jade Fakerson,
I'm reaching out because I want to make sure we're on the same page about how Jade is doing this grading period:
• 17 missing assignments across their classes
• 4 class(es) currently below 60%
• Current absence rate: 29.7%
Is there anything going on outside of school we should know about? …

4 drafts, one per family. Only real numbers from the snapshot. A person reads and sends.

3 "Schedule meetings with them"

Google Calendar · School calendar — INVITE NOT SENT

Parent meeting re: Jade Fakerson
Thursday, October 15 · 4:00 – 4:30 PM

PS parent.sample@example.com
Guardian · not notified yet

Notes on the invite:
• 17 missing assignments
• 4 class(es) below 60%
• Absence rate: 29.7%
Auto-drafted from the student snapshot.

4 events on the calendar. Guardians hear nothing until the principal hits Send.

LIVE DEMO · 4 OF 4

Reports

Replaces: manual exports + Word, and analytics add-ons

- At-Risk Executive Summary, building by building
- Tiers and top-10 tables in a Word document
- Board-ready reports like the PE waiver summary

BACKUP IF THE DEMO FAILS

Dashboard screenshots

Earlham Community School District

Attendance Report by Building and Grade

Report date: October 1, 2026 | August 24, 2026 – September 30, 2026

District Overview

Building	Students	Attend. rate	Avg days absent	Chronic (10%+)	At risk (5–10%)
Elementary (25 days)	307	96.9%	0.8	25 (8.1%)	41 (13.4%)
Middle School (25 days)	149	96.2%	0.9	18 (12.1%)	24 (16.1%)
High School (25 days)	193	95.9%	1.0	24 (12.	
District	**649**	**96.5%**	**0.9**	**67 (10.**	

Elementary by Grade

Grade	Students	Attend. rate	Avg days absent	Chronic
PreK	41	97.5%	0.6	4 (9.8%)
K	49	96.4%	0.9	5 (10.2%)
1	35	96.2%	1.0	4 (11.4%)
2	44	97.1%	0.7	3 (6.8%)
3	43	96.8%	0.8	2 (4.7%)
4	46	96.9%	0.8	5 (10.9%)
5	49	97.5%	0.6	2 (4.1%)
All Elementary	**307**	**96.9%**	**0.8**	**25 (8.1%)**

Middle School by Grade

Grade	Students	Attend. rate	Avg days absent	Chronic
6	60	97.1%	0.7	5 (8.3%)
7	46	97.3%	0.7	3 (6.5%)
8	43	93.9%	1.5	10 (23.3%)
All Middle School	**149**	**96.2%**	**0.9**	**18 (12.1%)**

Building	Grade	Brick & mortar	Non-brick & mortar	Total	% non-B&M	% B&M
MS	6	480	0	480	0.0%	100.0%
MS	7	361	0	361	0.0%	100.0%
MS	8	330	0	330	0.0%	100.0%
MS	**All**	**1,171**	**0**	**1,171**	**0.0%**	**100.0%**
HS	9	463	7	470	1.5%	98.5%
HS	10	310	9	319	2.8%	97.2%
HS	11	277	37	314	11.8%	88.2%
HS	12	252	79	331	23.9%	76.1%
HS	**All**	**1,302**	**132**	**1,434**	**9.2%**	**90.8%**
MS + HS	**All**	**2,473**	**132**	**2,605**	**5.1%**	**94.9%**

Earlham High School (172)

185 students enrolled. 43 are flagged at-risk (score ≥30): 12 in the Urgent tier (70+), 12 High Risk (50-69). 97 students are chronically absent (52.4% of the building). 23 behavior log entries were recorded for 20 students in-window.

Academic drivers dominate the top of this list — failing-grade counts and missing-assignment totals weigh heavily. Attendance and behavior pile on additional risk when present. The Flags column shows active compliance or enrollment signals (IEP, 504, ELL, homeless, foster, new enrollment).

Top Students by At-Risk Score

Student	Gr	Score	Classes <60%	Missing Assign.	Absence %	Chronic	Behavior Logs	Flags
Kendrick Lamar	9	100	4	16	23.2%	Yes	—	—
J. Cole	10	98	5	5	37.7%	Yes	1	No Activi
Travis Scott	9	98	3	10	14.5%	Yes	1	IEP
Lil Wayne	9	95	3	12	11.6%	Yes	—	—
Kanye West	9	93	3	6	15.9%	Yes	—	ELL
Jay-Z	11	90	5	3	24.6%	Yes	—	No Activi
Eminem	9	90	3	7	10.1%	Yes	—	—
Nicki Minaj	10	90	2	7	21.7%	Yes	—	No Activi
Cardi B	11	88	3	10	7.2%	No	—	ELL, No
Megan Stallion	9	83	4	0	7.2%	No	3	IEP, No

ding Resource Room.
Hall period counts as one) plus SchoolsPLP online courses.
so they aren't in the total either.

e outside the building, and 79 HS students take at least one. All 7 of
ks like a full-time SchoolsPLP student. **Central Campus is missing**
st of those students, I can add them, and the non-B&M share would

WHAT IT COSTS US

The costs to be honest about

- Builder time is the biggest cost
- Bus factor: what if the builder leaves? GitHub repo, docs, public copy
- AI subscriptions and API usage
- No vendor help desk. The district owns bugs, uptime, security
- Compliance: FERPA, Iowa student-data privacy, TCPA for texting, ADA Title II for the website

GUARDRAILS

Read-only until you have a tested reason not to be

Read

Never write to the systems of record

Draft

A human approves every message

Secure

Secrets in .env, kept out of the repo

Fake data

Demo and test without real students

EASY WINS

What you can start Monday, no API needed

Easy win	Why it's easy
Inbox summary + draft replies	Only needs Gmail; no student data
Start-of-year credential emails	CSV exports + a template; drafts only
Observation Scheduler	Only need a couple of items
SIS data cleanup (medical alerts)	Export → clean → import file, human reviews
One-off board/admin reports	CSV export → Word summary

The pattern: exports, not APIs · drafts, not sends · a human checks

WHAT'S NEXT AT EARLHAM

Still on the list

- District website: Claude-built and maintained, with an accessibility check on every update
- Student/Staff onboarding: one form to PowerSchool, parent access, Jamf (needs write access, so later)
- Reporting Portal
- School Messenger: a plan for emergency SMS/voice
- Ad hoc reporting
- ‘Ask Earlham’ chatbot trained on board policies, handbooks, DE rules etc

PROTECTING STUDENT DATA

Same rules as PowerSchool. Get the paperwork first.

Your account

- District K-12 or business plan, with a signed data privacy agreement
- Turn off “Help improve Claude” (model training)
- No thumbs up/down on student-data chats
- Delete chats you’re done with. Keep the process in a README

The data itself

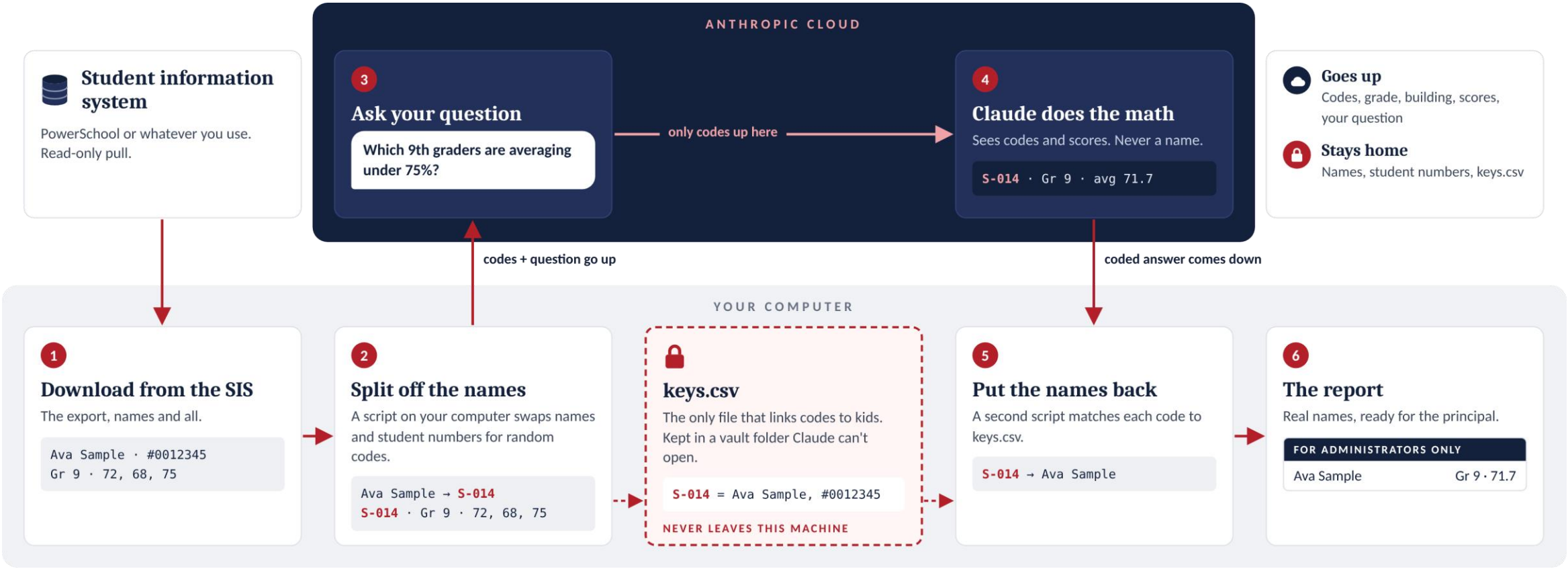
- Send only the fields the task needs
- Student numbers or initials, not names. Scripts put names back locally
- Read-only access to the SIS
- Fake data for demos and testing

Where it lands

- Keep files off personal iCloud, Dropbox or OneDrive
- Keep data and passwords out of code backups (.gitignore, .env)
- Drafts, not sends. A person approves
- Label reports: “for administrators only”

WHERE THE DATA GOES

The math can happen anywhere. Names stay home.



Claude only ever sees codes. The names and the key file never leave your computer.

DATA HYGIENE IN ONE PROMPT

Ask for a script, not a look

RISKY

"Here's a spreadsheet of student names and scores. Find each student's average."

Same thing as uploading the file to a chat.

WHAT GOES TO THE CLOUD

Every name and every score. Claude has to read the file to do the math, and it all stays in your chat history.

SAFER

"Don't open `grades.xlsx` yourself. Write a script that runs on my computer to:

1. make a copy with each name swapped for a code, and save the key as `key.csv`
2. average the scores in the coded copy
3. put the names back from the key and save `grades_averaged.xlsx`

If you need to check the data, look only at the coded copy. Never open `key.csv`."

WHAT GOES TO THE CLOUD

The script, a row count, and at most codes and scores. Your computer does the work. Names never leave it.

Safest of all: export from your SIS with student numbers only. A prompt is a promise, not a lock.

YOUR TURN

Audit your own stack

Worksheet: Tool · Annual cost · What job it does · Data it needs · Read access? · Holds data or reports on it? · Replace / Modify / Keep

Questions? · choughton@ecsdcards.com

github.com/cohawkeye/Agentic-Public